Lesson 38

The Judgement of Believers

(Adapted from the Life in the Spirit Study Bible)

Aim: To teach the believers the biblical teaching of the Judgement of believers.

Introduction:

“When I stand before God at the end of my life, I would hope that I would not have a single bit of talent left, and could say, 'I used everything you gave me.”— Erma Bombeck

2 Corinthians 5:10 *10For we must all appear before the judgment seat of Christ, that each one may receive what is due to him for the things done while in the body, whether good or bad.*

The Bible teaches that believers will someday have to give an account at “the judgement seat of Christ." Concerning the judgement of believers, the following facts should be kept in mind;

1. All Christians will be subject to Judgement; there will be no exceptions. Romans 14:12, 1 Cor. 3:12-15, 2 Cor. 5:10

2. This judgement will occur when Christ returns for His church. John 14:3, 1 Thess. 4:14-17

3. The judge is Christ. John 5:22, 2 Tim. 4:8

4. The Bible speaks of the believer's judgement as something solemn and serious, especially since it includes the possibility of damage or "loss" (1Cor. 3:15; 2John 8), Of being ashamed before Him " at His coming" (1John 2:8) and of burning up of one's whole life's work (1 Cor. 3:13-15). The believers' judgement, however, will not involve a declaration of condemnation by God.

5. Everything will be made Manifest. The word appear Gk. Phanee, 2 Cor. 5:10 means "to be revealed Openly or publicly" God will examine and openly reveal, in its true reality.

A. Our secret acts. Mark 4:22, Ro. 2:16

B. Our character Romans 2:5-11

C. Our words Matthew 12:36-37

D. Our good deeds Eph. 6:8

E. Our attitudes Mark 5:22

F. Our motives 1Cor. 4:5

G. Our lack of love Col. 3:18- 4:1

H. And our work and ministry 1 Cor. 3:13

6. In sum, believers will have to give an account of their faithfulness or unfaithfulness to God (Matt. 25:21,23, 1Cor. 4:2-5) and of their deeds in light of the grace, opportunity and understanding made available to them (Luke 12:48, John 5:24, Ro. 8:1)

7. The believer's bad deeds, when repented of, are forgiven with respect to eternal punishment (Romans 8:1), but they are still taken into account when being judged for repayment:" he that doeth wrong shall receive for the wrong which he hath done" Col. 3:5, Ecc. 12:14, 1Cor. 3:15, 2 Co. 5:10). The believer's good deeds and love are remembered by God and rewarded (He. 6:10)" Whatsoever good thing any man doeth, the same shall he receive of the Lord" (Eph. 6:8).

8. The specific results of the believer's judgement will be varied. There will be either the gain or loss of joy (1John :28), divine approval (Matthew 25:21), task and authority (Matt. 25:14-30), position (Matt. 5:19, 19:30), rewards (1 Cor. 3:12-14; Phil. 3:14, 2 Tim 4:8 and honor (Rom. 2:10, 1 Peter 1:7)

9. The impending judgement of Christians should perfect in them the fear of the Lord (2 Cor. 5:11; Phil. 2:12; 1 Pet. 1:17) and cause them to be clear minded and self-controlled, to watch and pray (1 Peter 4:5,7), to live holy and godly lives (2 Peter 3:11), and to show mercy and kindness to all (Matt. 5:7; 2Tim. 1:16-18)